

# ACME CORP

## Code of Conduct

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*Note: This document contains synthetic, AI-generated sample data created for a university demonstration project. Acme Corp is a fictional company. No real organization's confidential information is represented here.*

### 1. Purpose and Scope

This Code of Conduct sets the standard of professional and ethical behavior expected of every Acme Corp employee, officer, and director, regardless of role, location, or level of seniority.

### 2. Workplace Conduct and Respect

Acme Corp is committed to maintaining a workplace free from discrimination, harassment, and retaliation. All employees are expected to treat colleagues, clients, and partners with professionalism and respect.

Discrimination or harassment based on race, gender, age, religion, disability, sexual orientation, national origin, or any other protected characteristic will not be tolerated and may result in disciplinary action up to and including termination.

### 3. Reporting Harassment or Misconduct

Employees who witness or experience misconduct should report it to their manager, Human Resources, or anonymously through the Acme Corp Ethics Hotline at 1-800-555-0199, available 24 hours a day.

Acme Corp strictly prohibits retaliation against any employee who reports misconduct in good faith, even if the underlying complaint is not ultimately substantiated after investigation.

### 4. Conflicts of Interest

Employees must disclose any actual or potential conflict of interest to their manager and the Compliance team, including outside employment, board memberships, or financial interests in vendors, competitors, or clients.

- Employees may not participate in hiring, vendor selection, or purchasing decisions where a close family member or personal relationship could influence, or appear to influence, the outcome.
- Undisclosed conflicts of interest discovered after the fact may result in disciplinary action regardless of intent.

### 5. Gifts and Anti-Bribery

Employees may accept business gifts from vendors or clients valued under \$75 without prior approval. Gifts exceeding \$75 must be reported to the employee's manager and may need to be

declined or donated.

Acme Corp strictly prohibits offering, giving, soliciting, or accepting bribes, kickbacks, or improper payments of any kind, in compliance with the Foreign Corrupt Practices Act (FCPA) and applicable international anti-corruption laws.

## **6. Confidentiality**

Employees must protect confidential company information, trade secrets, and customer data both during and after their employment at Acme Corp, consistent with the terms of their signed confidentiality agreement.

Discussing unreleased financial results, product roadmaps, or M&A; activity outside of approved channels is strictly prohibited and may constitute a violation of insider trading regulations.

## **7. Disciplinary Process**

Violations of this Code of Conduct are investigated by Human Resources and, where applicable, the Legal and Compliance teams. Outcomes may range from a documented verbal warning to immediate termination, depending on the severity and nature of the violation.